NUSUK CONSULT

DEPLOYMENT GUIDE

Hosting Manual

> Put the NUSUK CONSULT platform live on your own domain with cPanel — step by step, with pictures.

www.hausaly.com/nusuk · Truehost cPanel · Node.js 22

cPanel hosting
with “Setup Node.js App”

Node.js 22.13+
in the version list

Domain pointed
DNS → your hosting

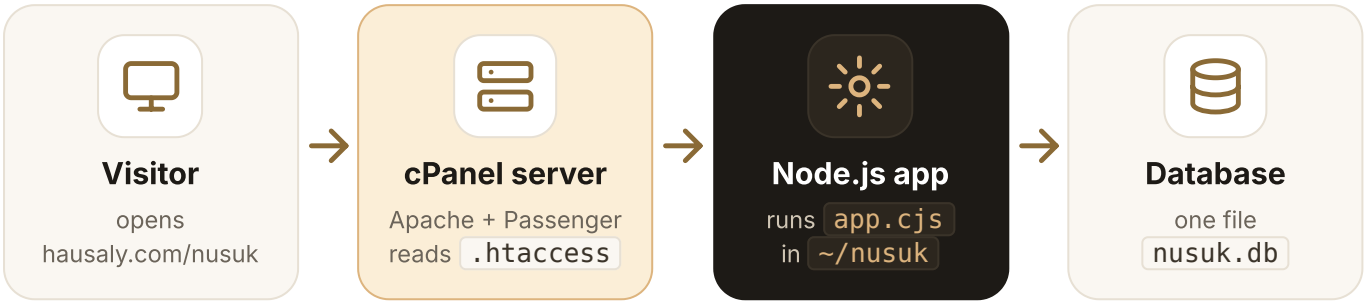
Project ZIP
downloaded from GitHub

About 20–30 minutes · No coding · No terminal

OVERVIEW

The big picture

What happens when someone opens your site — and where everything lives.



Where the files live

```
/home/<cpanel-user>/
  nusuk/            APP ROOT · code
    app.cjs         startup file
    package.json
    server/         backend
    public/         website files
  nusuk-data/       DATABASE · never delete
  public_html/      main site · .htaccess fix
```

Why it is built this way

- ✓ **No installs.** Nothing to download or compile on the server.
- ✓ **Data is safe.** The database sits *outside* the code folder, so updates never erase it.
- ✓ **Sub-path ready.** Runs at `/nusuk` next to your existing website.
- ✓ **Secure login.** Admin passwords are hashed; sessions are HTTPS-only.

⚠ **Golden rule.** `app.cjs`, `server/` and `public/` must sit **directly** inside `nusuk/` — not inside another folder.

✓ Correct

```
nusuk/
 ├ app.cjs
 ├ server/
 └ public/
```

✗ Wrong (one folder too deep)

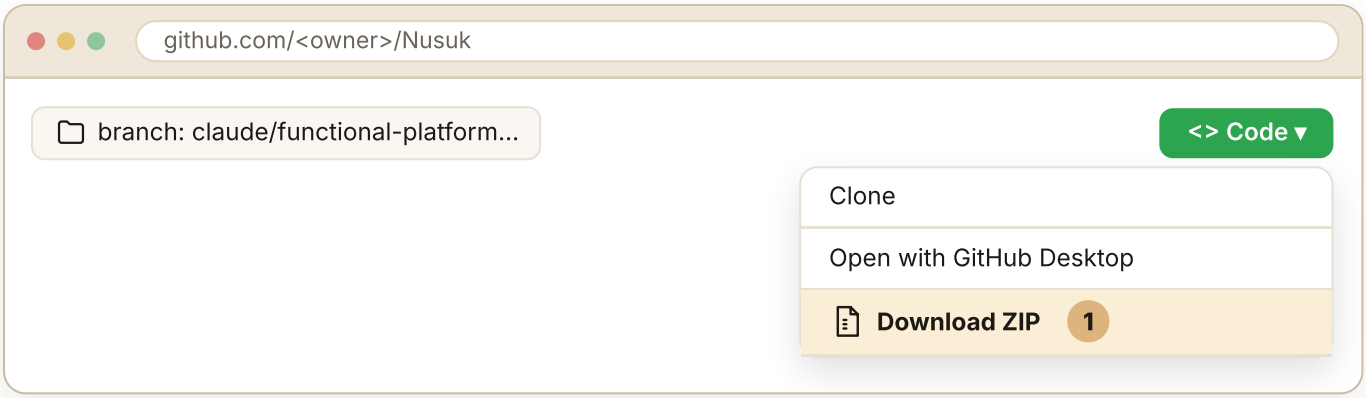
```
nusuk/
 └ Nusuk-claude-…/
    ├ app.cjs
    └ server/
```

STEPS 1 – 2

Get the code onto the server

1 Download the project from GitHub

Choose the branch, then Code → Download ZIP.



You receive `Nusuk-<branch>.zip` on your computer.

2 Upload and extract in cPanel File Manager

a — Create the folder
In your home folder make `nusuk`

b — Upload the ZIP
Open `nusuk` → **Upload**

c — Extract
Right-click ZIP → **Extract**

d — Move up
Select All → **Move** to `/nusuk`

> ⚠ Turn on **Settings → Show Hidden Files** before moving, so no file is missed. Then delete the empty extracted folder and the ZIP.

cPanel · File Manager — /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk

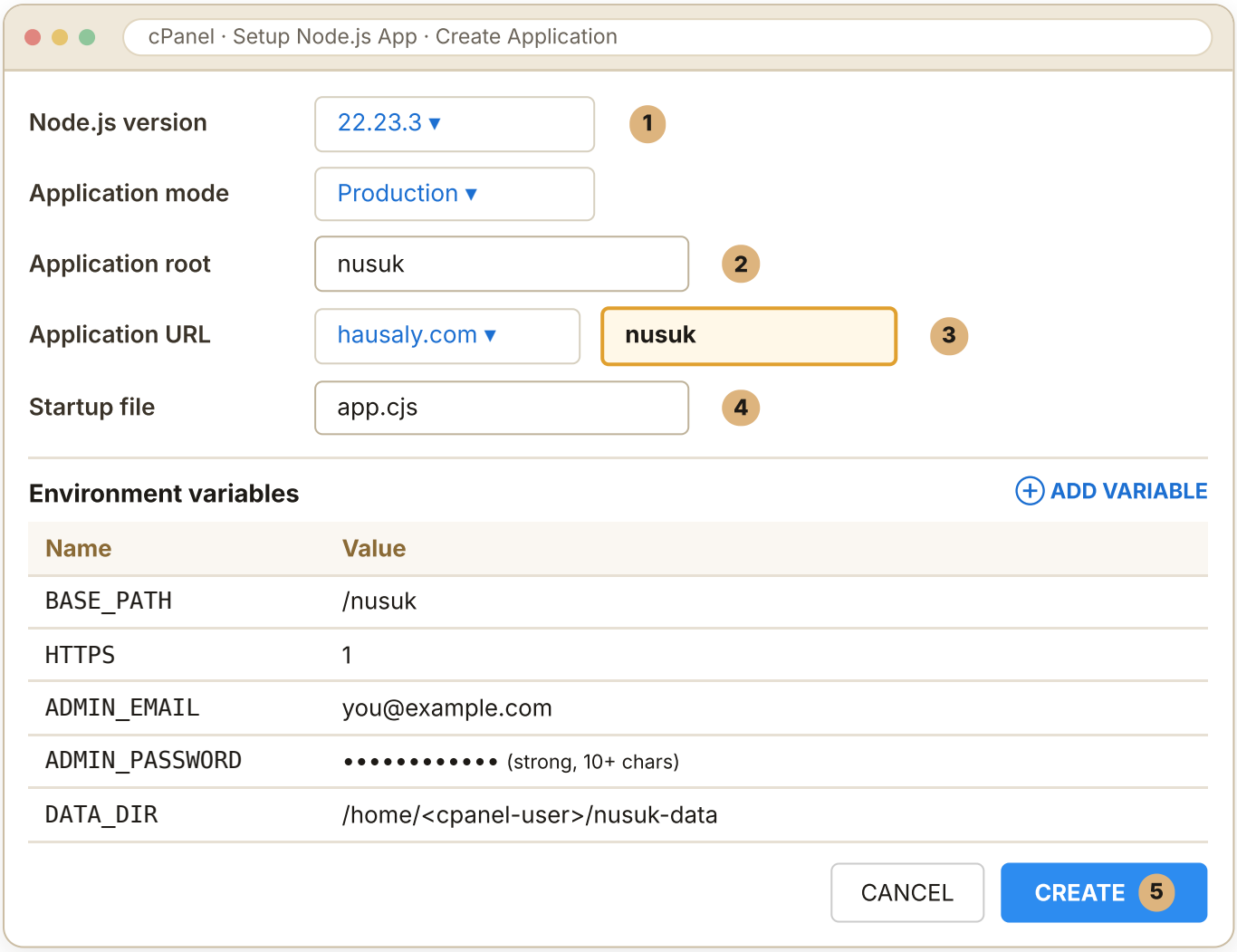
Name	Type
server	folder
public	folder
test	folder
tmp	folder
app.cjs	file
package.json	file

✔ What the folder should look like when finished.

STEP 3

Create the Node.js app

cPanel → **Setup Node.js App** → **Create Application**



1. Pick **22.x** and mode **Production**. An old Node (e.g. 10.x) causes 404 / 503 errors.
2. The folder from Step 2: `nusuk`.
3. **Type `nusuk` in the path box.** If empty, the site shows a black 404.
4. Startup file is exactly `app.cjs`.
5. Click **Create**, then **Restart**.

First start only. `ADMIN_EMAIL` and `ADMIN_PASSWORD` create the first admin the first time the app runs. Change the password later in **Dashboard → Users**.

Never share screenshots of this screen — it shows your password. **Do not add the Paystack key here**: put it in a `.env` file (see page 7).

STEP 4 · REQUIRED ON TRUEHOST

Fix the .htaccess file

Truehost adds a WordPress rule that hijacks every web address that is not a real file — including the app's own API. Remove it.

✕ Without the fix

hausaly.com/nusuk/ → **page loads** (static file)

hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health → **404 black page**

Login button → **"Request failed"**

✓ With the fix

hausaly.com/nusuk/ → **page loads**

hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health → **{"ok":true}**

Login button → **works**

1 Find the right file

a — **Show hidden files**

File Manager → Settings

b — **Open the right .htaccess**

The one containing `PassengerAppRoot`

c — **Copy it first**

Name it `.htaccess.bak`

2 Delete only this block

```
# DO NOT REMOVE. CLOUDLINUX PASSENGER CONFIGURATION BEGIN
PassengerAppRoot "/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk"
PassengerBaseURI "/nusuk"  …  PassengerStartupFile app.cjs
# … HTTPS redirect, security rules …
# BEGIN WordPress
RewriteEngine On
RewriteBase /
RewriteRule ^index\.php$ - [L]
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-f
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-d
RewriteRule . /index.php [L]
# END WordPress
# … rest of the file …
```

Keep — Delete these 8 lines

3 Save and restart

Click **Save Changes**, then **Setup Node.js App → Restart**.

⚠ If Truehost ever regenerates this file and the 404 returns, repeat these steps.

STEP 5

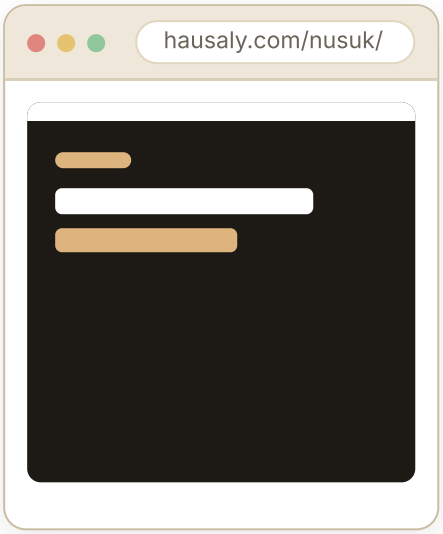
Check that it works

1 Health check



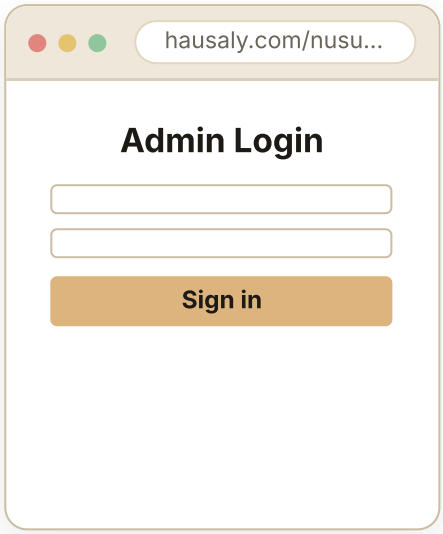
Must show exactly this.

2 The website



Keep the trailing `/`.

3 Admin login



Use your `ADMIN_EMAIL`.

First things to do after logging in

1 · Change your password

Dashboard → Users → Edit. Use 10+ characters.

2 · Set the FX rate

Settings → Platform FX rate. Naira per 1 Riyal. Shows in the top bar.

3 · Add links

Settings → brochures & YouTube. Buttons stay off until filled.

4 · Add staff

Users → Add. Role **staff** can't see Users or Settings.

5 · Privacy Policy

Replace the placeholder text before launch.

6 · Send a test

Submit the Interest Form → see it in Service Requests.

What the dashboard gives you

Overview · Service Requests · DIY Orders · Hotel Inventory · Offers · Email List · Users · Settings

Requests and bookings: search · status workflow · internal notes · CSV export.

MAINTENANCE

Updating the live site

Use this every time you receive new files.

1. **Back up** — Download `nusuk.db`
2. **Update pack** — or ZIP from GitHub
3. **Clear old code** — see list below
4. **Upload + move** — extract into `nusuk`
5. **Restart** — Setup Node.js App
6. **Test** — health + Ctrl+Shift+R

Delete from `nusuk/`

- folders `public` · `server` · `test`
- files `app.cjs` · `package.json` · `README.md` · `Dockerfile`
- the old extracted folder and old ZIP

Never delete

- `nusuk-data/` — **your database**
- `tmp/` — used by cPanel
- `.env` — your Paystack key
- the Passenger lines in `.htaccess`

Small update pack? It holds only the changed files in their folders. Upload it into `nusuk`, Extract, choose **Overwrite** — no deleting needed — then Restart and check the build number at `/api/health`.

Do I need to restart?

What changed	Restart app?	Hard-refresh?
Only files in `public/` (design, text, images)	No	Yes
Anything in `server/` or `app.cjs`	Yes	Yes
Environment variables	Yes	No

Backups & recovery

Back up

Download `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` weekly and before every update. It holds all requests, bookings, users and settings.

Restore

Upload the saved `nusuk.db` into `nusuk-data/` and restart the app.

Lost admin password

Rename `nusuk.db` to `nusuk.db.old`, set new admin variables, restart. A fresh admin is created.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Something not working?

Start at the top and follow the arrows.

Open `hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health`

Shows {"ok":true}

Can't log in or forms fail?

→

Hard-refresh **Ctrl+Shift+R**
Use **https://** (not http)
Check `ADMIN_EMAIL` spelling

Anything else

What do you see?

Black 404 page
① Path box `nusuk` filled?
② Files not one folder too deep?
③ WordPress block removed from `.htaccess`?
→ then **Restart**

500 / 503 / "Incomplete response"
The app crashed. Open `nusuk/stderr.log` and `nusuk/boot.log` in File Manager and read the last lines.

No `boot.log` at all
cPanel isn't running the app. Startup file must be `app.cjs`, root `nusuk`, app status **Started**.

⚠ Quick symptom table

Symptom	Fix
Logged out immediately after login	`HTTPS=1` is set but you opened `http://` — use `https://`
Old design still showing	Browser cache — **Ctrl+Shift+R**
Brochure / video buttons greyed out	Add the links in **Dashboard → Settings** (brochures then ask for an email)
503 after adding the Paystack key as a variable	Delete the variable; put the key in `.env`; Restart
Payments show Manual / Test mode	`.env` missing or misspelt — recreate it and Restart. A hand edit that doesn't show needs a new build number.
404 returns after some days	Host rewrote `.htaccess` — repeat Step 4
Node version list stops below 22	Ask Truehost to enable Node 22, or use a VPS

🔍 **Other places to look:** cPanel → **Metrics → Errors** shows recent server errors. Delete `boot.log` and `stderr.log` once everything works.

REFERENCE

Quick reference & security

QUICK REFERENCE CARD	
Website	**https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/**
Admin login	**https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/#/login**
Health check	**https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health**
App folder	**/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk**
Startup file	**app.cjs**
Database	**/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db**
Restart	**cPanel → Setup Node.js App → Restart**

Environment variables

Name	Example	Purpose
`BASE_PATH`	/nusuk	Serve under a sub-path (empty = domain root)
`HTTPS`	1	Secure cookies; use when the site is on https
`ADMIN_EMAIL`	you@example.com	First administrator (first start only)
`ADMIN_PASSWORD`	••••••••••	First password (first start only)
`DATA_DIR`	/home/.../nusuk-data	Where the database is kept
`NOTIFY_WEBHOOK_URL`	(optional)	Posts a message for each new request or booking

Security checklist

- ☐ Admin password changed after first login
- ☐ `DATA_DIR` is outside `public_html`
- ☐ Staff use the **staff** role, not admin
- ☐ Paystack key is in `.env`, regenerated if ever exposed
- ☐ Screenshots never show environment values
- ☐ Site is on https and `HTTPS=1` is set
- ☐ Database backups stored away from the server
- ☐ Email list used only for permitted marketing

NUSUK CONSULT
Beyond Compliance